VOL. I — NO. 006
CHATHAM, N.J.
EPEE ONLY

The EN GARDE GAZETTE
THE ELITE FENCERS CLUB WEEKLY

MONDAY EDITION
OCTOBER 19, 2026
PRICE: ONE TOUCH

MONDAY RESULTS EDITION · OCTOBER 19, 2026 · SAMPLE CONTENT · ISSUE NO. 006 · CHATHAM, N.J.

# Team USA Sweeps Pan-Am Epee Gold in Lima

*Comebacks in both team finals cap a six-gold weekend for the Americans in Lima.*

GAZETTE STAFF · EPEE ONLY, AS ALWAYS

The United States won all six team gold medals at the Pan American Senior Zonal Championships in Lima, Peru, with both epee squads delivering the weekend's best drama. The men trailed Venezuela 33–31 after seven legs before Gabriel Feinberg posted a 9–2 eighth leg, and anchor Ariel Simmons held off a 16–5 closing run from Colombia's John Edison Rodriguez to win 45–42. Elijah Imrek and Oleg Knysh fenced steady middle legs in the 14-team field, and the Americans never trailed after the eighth leg.

The women were even more commanding, beating Canada 41–31 behind Hadley Husisian, Catherine Nixon, Charlene Kai Yan Liu, and Tierna Oxenreider. In individual action, Anna van Brummen upset Husisian 15–13 for women's epee gold in a 68-fencer field. Van Brummen's run included three straight wins over higher seeds. The result continues a strong American run in Pan-American epee, with the men unbeaten in team play since last year's zonals. Full individual brackets are on the FIE site for fencers who want to study how the medalists built their touches. The bronze went to Brazil over Colombia, 45–34.

**Why it matters here:** zonals use the same relay format as our regional events — closing tight legs without panicking is exactly what coaches preach in our room. Feinberg's patience and Simmons holding a shrinking lead are the two hardest things in team fencing. The Gazette will have full individual results in Thursday's edition. For readers new to the format: a team match is a relay of nine legs, first team to 45 touches. Each leg ends after a multiple of five, so a fencer who inherits a 33–31 deficit starts their leg chasing two — exactly the arithmetic Feinberg solved with his 9–2. Anchors inherit pure arithmetic: Simmons started his final leg up two and never let Rodriguez within one. The relay also rewards programs with depth: all four Americans won individual bouts across the weekend. Nine legs, nine lead changes, one trophy.

## RATINGS EARNED

| NAME | RATING | EVENT |
|---|---|---|
| Maya R. | B26 | Cadet WE |
| Daniel K. | D26 | Y14 ME |
| Sofia L. | E26 | Y12 WE |
| James T. | A26 | Div IA ME |

## SCOREBOARD

| SRC | RESULT |
|---|---|
| FIE | Song reclaims world epee crown in priority-minute final |
| FIE | Budapest GP: Lehis, Santuccio set up epee showdown |
| USA | Junior men's epee takes first-ever world team title |
| NJ HS | Preseason polls: Chatham 3rd in epee |
| SYC | Four Elite FC fencers reach DEs in Edison |

## November NAC Takes Shape in Columbus

With Orlando in the books, eyes turn to Columbus, Ohio, where the November NAC runs Nov. 20–23 with Division I, junior, and cadet events. Regular-fee entries close Oct. 28 — the deadline box below has the details. The club travel group leaves Friday morning; contact the desk for hotel-block seats. Parents new to national events should ask for the travel FAQ sheet — check-in, armory checks, what to pack. Doors open at 8am for weapons check on day one.

## Chatham Ranked 3rd in Preseason Epee Poll

Preseason polls place Chatham third in boys' epee and fifth in girls', with several Elite FC fencers expected to anchor both squads. Dual meets begin in December, and rosters lock the first week of the month. High-school fencing is where many of our fencers first fence for something bigger than themselves. Preseason practices are already underway — check with your school coach for tryout dates. Returning varsity fencers report the first week of November.

## Winter Camp Returns Dec 27–31

Our ninth annual high-performance epee camp runs the last week of the year, 9:30am–2pm daily: footwork, technical and tactical drills, conditioning, video review, and a closing team tournament on Thursday. Open to all levels at $395 for the week or $95 a day, with a sibling discount. Spots are capped at thirty — the sign-up sheet is at the desk. All levels welcome, from first-year Y10s to NAC-bound juniors. Parents are welcome at the Thursday finale. Returning campers get first pick of practice groups. Loaner gear is available for first-time campers.

## SIGNUP BOARD — WHO'S IN

| TOURNAMENT | EVENTS (EPEE) | CLOSES | ELITE FC ENTERED |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hub City Fall Epee Open, New Brunswick | Y14 / Cadet / Senior Mixed | Oct 16 | Maya R., Daniel K., Sofia L. +4 |
| Garden State RJC, Edison | Cadet / Junior | Oct 21 | James T., Priya S. +2 |
| November NAC, Columbus OH | Div I / Junior / Cadet | Oct 28 | Travel group forming — ask at desk |
| Princeton Epee Open, Princeton | Y12 / Senior Mixed | Nov 4 | No Elite FC entries yet — be the first |

## New Passivity Rule Took Effect Oct 1: Red, Then Black

Under the new rule, stalling no longer earns a warning. The first passivity call goes straight to a **red card** — a touch for the opponent — and the second to a **black card**: exclusion from the bout. Yellow cards for passivity are gone entirely. The intent is to keep bouts fencing instead of circling. For our fencers the lesson is simple: always show the referee clear attacking intent, especially late in a period, because the call will now come faster and cost more. Expect referees to enforce it strictly through the fall while everyone adjusts.

## Ice Cream Makes Fencers Ten Times Better

A groundbreaking Gazette investigation of the club freezer confirms it: fencers who eat ice cream between periods win ten times as many bouts. Chocolate beats vanilla 15–14 in overtime. Side effects include sticky gloves and questionable footwork. More research — and sprinkles — needed.

### WHERE TO WATCH — EPEE ON SCREEN

| EVENT | WHEN | WATCH |
|---|---|---|
| October NAC replays — Div I epee finals | Anytime | USA Fencing YouTube (free) |
| Casablanca Epee World Cup | Oct 15–18 | FencingTV.com (sub.) |
| Veteran Worlds, Tbilisi | Oct 9–17 | FencingTV.com (sub.) |
| First to 15 podcast | Anytime | Podcast apps (free) |
| November NAC, Columbus — Div I epee | Nov 20–23 | USA Fencing YouTube (free) |
| Youth Olympics, Dakar — epee | Fall 2026 | Olympic Channel (free) |

**Watch like a fencer:** pick one fencer and count their advances before each touch. You'll start seeing the setup two moves before the light goes on — that's distance, and it's the whole weapon. Bring a notebook; the best fencers steal one idea per bout. Rewatch the final period twice: once for footwork, once for bladework.

### DEADLINES

| DATE | DEADLINE |
|---|---|
| Oct 16 | Hub City Open entries close |
| Oct 21 | Garden State RJC prereg closes |
| Oct 28 | November NAC regular-fee deadline |
| Nov 1 | USFA membership renewals due |
| Nov 15 | Hub City late entries close |

### NEXT GAZETTE — THURSDAY

Full signup board, late-entry locals, and weekend logistics. On the club desk Thursday morning.

### CLUB THIS WEEK

| DAY | WHAT'S ON |
|---|---|
| Mon–Fri | 3–9pm classes + open fencing |
| Saturday | 8:30am–3pm; 10am Y10/Y12 practice tournament |
| Sunday | Closed |
| Dec 27–31 | Winter Camp — sign up at desk |

### NEW FACES

Saturday tryouts brought four new beginners into the club, ages eight to twelve, all starting in epee. They spent the morning learning the guard position, the advance, and the most important lesson of all: how to salute. Returning members are asked to say hello on the strip — everyone remembers their first night holding a weapon that felt impossibly long. Parents: the beginner parent briefing runs the first Tuesday of each month at 6pm.

### FENCING 101 — THE DOUBLE TOUCH

Epee has no right-of-way: if both fencers hit within about 40 milliseconds, **both score**. That's why you see 1–1 counters where foil would give one light. Lesson for beginners: when you're up by one late in a bout, don't chase — make them come to you, because a double keeps your lead. When you're down, avoid the double at all costs; only single-light touches change the math. Tied at the end of a direct-elimination bout, epee goes to a one-minute priority round after a draw for who advances on a tie — win the draw and the pressure flips entirely: your opponent must score, and any double touch goes to you as the priority holder. Body contact is its own lesson: corps-à-corps to avoid a touch is penalized, so keep your distance honest even when the strip gets crowded. When in doubt, ask the referee to explain the call after the bout.

### CLUB RESULTS

| EVENT | FINISH |
|---|---|
| Garden State RJC | Maya R. 6th, Cadet WE |
| Garden State RJC | Daniel K. T8, Y14 ME |
| Hub City Open | Sofia L. 3rd, Y12 WE |
| Edison SYC | Two medals, Y14 |

### MILESTONES

**50th Gazette touch:** thank you to everyone who squinted at the early versions. **Welcome** to our four newest beginners from Saturday tryouts. **Good luck** to the Orlando travel group at the October NAC. **100-DE club:** congratulations to Daniel K., who fenced his 100th recorded direct-elimination bout this month — the first hundred are the hardest. **Blade milestone:** Sofia L. broke her first blade in competition and kept fencing. That's not a loss, that's an initiation. **Strip record:** Saturday's practice tournament drew twenty-two fencers, our biggest in-club turnout this season. **Travel roster:** six Elite FC fencers are confirmed for the November NAC — see the signup board. **Welcome back** to Elena V., returning from a semester away. **First stripe:** congratulations to our newest beginners on completing their first month of classes.

**[ COMIC ]**

*Frank's panel goes here.*
*Bot reserves this space.*

### ABOUT THIS PAPER

Edited by Frank, printed at the club. Tips, links, and comics go by email to the paper's inbox. No bylines for the editor; guests get credited. Past issues live in the binder at the club desk — ask for the Gazette archive.